

OMAN

Oman: Key Country Details

Detail	Information
Full Name	Sultanate of Oman
Short Form	Oman
Capital	Muscat
Region (UN)	Asia-Pacific Group
Government Type	Absolute Monarchy
Head of State	Sultan Haitham bin Tariq Al Said
Head of Government	Sultan Haitham bin Tariq Al Said
Currency	Omani Rial (OMR)
UN Member Since	7 October 1971
MUN Standing	Active in mediation and peacekeeping, focus on regional security and economic development

Book Recommendations

Book Title	Author	Why It's Useful
Oman: Politics and Society in the Qaboos State	Calvin H. Allen Jr.	Comprehensive analysis of Oman's political system
The Sultanate of Oman	Peter Vine	Overview of Oman's foreign policy and regional role
Oman in the Twenty-First Century	Marc Valeri	Recent political and social developments
Oman's Foreign Policy and Regional Relations	Ibrahim Al Abri	Useful for UNSC and ECOSOC perspectives
Oman and the Gulf: The Dynamics of Regional Security	Anthony H. Cordesman	Insight into Oman's security policies

Research Table: Oman & the UNHRC

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
OHCHR – Oman Country Profile	OHCHR Oman (ohchr.org)	Official overview of Oman's UPR and rights mechanisms—essential baseline for UNHRC analysis.
OHCHR – Oman UPR Index & Docs	UPR Oman	Includes all official UPR cycle reports, questions, outcomes, and stakeholder submissions.
HRW – Oman UPR Submission (2020)	HRW UPR Submission	NGO analysis of freedoms of expression and assembly under Article 29—relevant to HRC item 6.
Amnesty International – UPR Oman 2021 (PDF)	Amnesty UPR Report	Covers expression, women's rights, death penalty, children's and migrant rights.
UN WebTV – Oman UPR Consideration (2016)	Oman UPR Video	Watch the live interactive dialogue—excellent for seeing stakeholder questions.
UPR Info – Oman Hub	UPR Info Oman	Central source for Oman UPR documents, stakeholder inputs, mid-term analysis.
Freedom House – Oman Profile	Freedom House Oman	Independent ratings of civil liberties and political rights—revision for UNHRC context.
US State Dept – Oman 2022 HR Report (PDF)	Oman 2022 Report	Government overview of due process, freedoms, worker rights, and minority protections.
OHCHR – UPR Working Group Report	WG Report Oman	Official summary of recommendations and state responses in UPR Working Group.
HRW Country Page – Oman	HRW Oman	Focuses on arrests under penal code—key reference for legal reform monitoring.
Amnesty Country Page – Oman	Amnesty Oman	Ongoing updates on civil rights, migrant worker conditions, executions.
UN WebTV – HRC 58 Session (28th Mtg)	HRC58 Video	Visual reference for when Oman is discussed or answers questions in Council.

UPR Info Mid-Term Assessment (PDF)	Oman MIA 2014	Tracks the implementation progress of UPR recommendations—helps evaluate follow-up.
US State Dept – Oman 2023 HR Report (PDF)	Oman 2023 Report	Most recent executive assessment across rights themes under HRC review.
Freedom House – Oman 2024	FH Oman 2024	Recent data on rights restrictions and evolving trends.
Climate Rights – Oman Profile	Climate Rights Oman	Documents obligations and practices linking rights and climate change—crucial UNHRC-SDG synergy.
GCHRAGD – UPR National Report PDF	Oman UPR National Report	Includes Oman’s official self-assessment of treaty accession and implementation.
OHCHR Stakeholder Summary	Stakeholder Info S37	Lists NGO and UN agency inputs for the 3rd UPR—good for civil society perspective.
Advocates for HR – CEDAW PDF	CEDAW Conformity Oman	Analyses Oman’s alignment with women’s rights treaty—useful for gender equality agenda.
UN WebTV – HRC58 24th Mtg	Meeting Video	HRC meeting that may include references to Oman or regional statement context.
UNESCO – Oman Country Profile	UNESCO Oman	Cultural rights and dialogue statistics feed into HRC thematic areas.
UN Digital Library – Oman UPR Compilation	Compilation UPR	Refined UPR compilation of OHCHR-prepared materials—historical continuity.
HRW – Children’s Rights Submission (2020)	Children Rights Oman	Highlights issues around guardianship and FGM—supports UNCRC agenda.
Amnesty 2018 Review PDF	Amnesty 2018 Report	Covers prison mistreatment and women’s rights—baseline for trend analysis.
Freedom House Historic PDF	FH Oman PDF	Contextualizes Oman’s civil liberties over time—aids comparative analysis.
UNESCO Business Rights Report	OHCHR Business Report	Includes Oman case references—useful for corporate accountability interests.
CIVICUS – Human Rights Restrictions Article	Civics Oman	NGO monitoring highlighting extensive civil society limits—useful for UNHRC advocacy.

UK Parliament Briefing PDF	Oman UPR Briefing	Highlights UPR cycles and NGO inputs—useful for legislative comparative framing.
UN WebTV – HRC 57 (15th Mtg)	HRC57 Video	HRC session that may discuss Oman or regional human rights patterns.
Executive Office – EOIR Oman Profile	EOIR Oman	US immigration and detention profile—links to UNHRC refugee/detention themes.
UN Data – Oman Statistics	UN Data Oman	National data source—useful for socio-economic baseline supporting rights analysis.

Unique Aspects: Oman's UNHRC Context

1. **Hereditary Monarchy, Not Free Status:** Oman's Freedom House rating of "Not Free" sheds light on its centralized governance approach and the tight restrictions placed on civil and political liberties.
2. **UPR Engagement with Limited Reforms:** Oman is quite active in the Universal Periodic Review (UPR), but both Amnesty International and Human Rights Watch point out that there's been very little actual implementation of the recommendations. This highlights a disconnect between what's reported internationally and the changes happening on the ground.
3. **Migrant Work and the Kafala System:** Reports about kafala abuses highlight the dire conditions faced by migrant workers, making it a key topic in the Human Rights Council's discussions on labor and human trafficking.
4. **Rights-Based Climate Policy Linkage:** Oman's responsibilities concerning climate-induced displacement connect human rights and environmental issues within the frameworks of the UN Human Rights Council and the Sustainable Development Goals.
5. **Civil Society Constraints:** The strict limitations placed on NGOs during UPR cycles really highlight the challenges that stakeholders face when trying to participate—this has a significant impact on the inclusivity of the UNHRC.
6. **Gender and Children's Rights Gaps:** Persistent issues with guardianship laws, prison conditions, and female genital mutilation (FGM) continue to be key topics in discussions between CEDAW and CRC at the Human Rights Council.

7. **Death Penalty Legality:** Amnesty and Human Rights Watch point out that while the legality remains in place—though it's not often enforced—Oman continues to be monitored by the Council regarding its abolition.
 8. **Corporate Human Rights Initiatives:** Participation in Corporate Human Rights NAPs suggest private sector reforms linked to UNGPs and the Business & HR agenda.
 9. **Interaction with International Mechanisms:** Iran's initial visits to the UN Human Rights Council in 2025 showed improved access, yet Oman continues to be under-monitored because of a limited civil society presence.
 10. **Sympathetic Refugee Resettlement Host:** Hosting Guantánamo detainees highlights Oman's growing involvement in humanitarian issues and discussions about displacement at the UNHRC.
-

Diplomind